

Chapter : 4

Business Communication
in ethical context.**Ethics:-**

Ethics is the branch of philosophy, in which we study about values and customs of a person. It covers the analysis and employment of concepts such as right and wrong, good and evil.

Ethical Communication:-

Ethical Communication is a type of communication that is predicted upon certain business values, such as being truthful, concise and responsible with one's words and action.

Ethical Situations:-

A person can make ethical decisions every day and the decisions build on a concept of right and wrong.

For example Someone is witness another student cheating

during an important accounting exam. Here he will take the decision. He will think that he confront the student, or he tell other student or a professor about the incident.

A quick response to such situations is that someone would always make the right and moral decision.

post paper.

Ethics as a Communication issue:-

We communicate our values and beliefs to others via verbal and nonverbal behavior.

Ethics can become as a communication issue if our behavior is not according to. Because we are defined in the eyes of others according to the way we behave.

So we need to communicate to others the important and necessity of good ethics.

Ethical leaders speak

out when something is wrong.
these people influence other
by acting in line with
their personal values.

Influence on personal ethics

There are five
major influence shape in our
personal ethics.

- People ✓
- Culture ✓
- Philosophy ✓
- Law ✓
- Religion ✓

People:-

People have great
influence on our ethics. First
of all our family members
and friend exert strong
influence on our ethics. As
parents are first teachers so
they shaped our ethical values
system early on.

our second teachers
are our college or school
teachers who are also influential
especially when a person is

younger, these teachers laid the foundation for ethical decision.

Culture:-

Culture has also a great role in shaping ethical behavior of the people. ~~with~~ culture help all the people and human beings to learn what to do, how to use, how to produce.

Culture also help people to know and believe as they grow to maturity and live out their lives in social groups to which they belong. e.g. cultural dance.

Philosophy:-

Philosophy means 'love of wisdom'. It can be defined as an activity people undertake when they seek to understand fundamental truths about themselves.

Theories of philosophy have long been concerned with ethical and moral

issues. With business ethics we are primarily concerned with what is moral and right and contribute positively to the human experience.

There are four concepts of ethics in philosophy.

- Theologism
- Teleology
- Utilitarianism
- Deontologism.

Theologism:-

Theologism is the systematic study of nature of divine and more broadly of religious. It is a moral perspective that attempt to pattern ^{the} actions according to God's will. For example, "what would God have me do in this situation".

Deontology:-

Deontology is derived from Greek word 'Duty'. It is the study of the nature of duty and obligations. According to this

perspective morality of action
should be based on
whether that action itself
is right or wrong, under
a series of rules, rather
than based on the consequences
of the action.

In simple worlds
actions are not justified by
their consequences. Factors
determines the rightness of
actions. For example,

"They believe that you
should always tell truth."

Teleology:

According to this
perspective the explanation of
phenomena in term of the
purpose they serve rather
than of the cause by
which they arise. On
simple worlds consequences are
driven approach. For example,

"They believe that the
singular duty is to
maximize good consequences."

Utilitarianism:

Utilitarianism is a theory of morality that advocates actions that foster happiness or pleasure and oppose actions that cause unhappiness or harm.

According to this perspective morality of an action can be determined by its consequences. An action is ethical if it promotes the greatest good for the greatest number.

Law:

Law can be defined as any official statement or set of rules used to govern the society. Some individuals view ethics from a legal perspective. Acting ethically means following laws. Codes of ethics for various professions, such as accounting, law and medicine requires standards of behavior that exceed law.

Religion:-

Religion can be define as a particular system of faith and worship. Religion throughout the world are major foundations for ethical behavior among followers. Using religion as the grounding for your ethical behavior means you at according to what you believe God wants you to do.

past paper Communication and Ethical issues

organizational challenges includes developing a productive company culture with employees having diverse background values and beliefs. besides it following are other ethical issues in communication.

- Legal issues
- Key areas for ethical communications.
- Ethics and organizational

Legal Issues:-

when we are doing business it involves different types of legal issues. The most important legal issue is defamation. The word 'defamation' derived from 'Defame' meaning that damaging someone's fame, name, and reputation by written or oral communication. It involve false statements.

- when we defame someone by written message is called libel or written defamation.

- when we defame someone by oral message is called slander or oral defamation.

Following are some types of legal issue.

- Privacy ✓
- Harassment ✓
- Plagiarism ✓
- Copy Rights ✓

Privacy

Leak out someone's personal chat picture or something else

is called privacy issue. It is also a privacy legal issue and violation against privacy. When organizations or individual violate the privacy of a person by passing information to third party they can be found guilty of invasion of privacy.

Harasment: past paper

Harasment involves irritating or tormenting another person on a repeated basis. It can occur between coworkers, Supervisor and subordinate and people of different culture. Harasment is both illegal and unethical. It is a poor way of communication of feelings and also violate principle of fairness for other people.

Plagiarism: SS, U, J

Plagiarism is also an ethical issue. It involves taking the idea or written material of another person.

and using it as one's own.
Most of the students are
involved in plagiarism and
they may suffer academic integrity
penalties. It is also an
unethical and bad way of
communication.

Copyright

A Copyright is granted
to an author, publisher, or
distributor for the exclusive
publication, sale and distribution
of an original work.
Violating copy-right is both
unethical and illegal. In
copy-right the originators of
work may sue to reclaim
any losses caused by the
copyright violation.

Key Areas for ethical Communication

Key areas for
ethical communication means
where we can discuss the
ethical communication. It takes
time, thought and preparation.
Following are key areas of

of ethical communication

- Written and Spoken message.
- Cross culture message
- Advertising message.

Written and Spoken message.

The written and Spoken message involves

- Message Purpose
- Research methods
- Selection material
- Development of ideas
- Use of language
- Ethical context
- Self analysis.

Cross culture message:

It says that do not take advantage of misunderstandings of different cultures. For example there is a culture where people even do not know what is lie so one should not take advantage of it. one should must be done things in the culture context and also try to avoid misunderstandings

At the end one should not use the supremacy of language.

Advertising message:

It is ethically wrong to advertise product in ways that confuse. For example gaining customers through false advertising is both unlawful and unethical. E.g. Fat free. one should also try to avoid showing negativity to a specific person.

Ethics and organizational responsibility:

organizations dominate our life and workplace, these organizations typically attempt to create a corporate culture. The organizations are stronger than individuals.

Formal v/s informal ways of communication

Companies must determine whether the ethical values should be suggested from top down or bottom up.

past paper
short
question

- Formal ways
- Informal ways.

Formal ways.

In formal way one company may have one or more role-model companies in ethics. The companies having formal ways may use Top-down approach for ethical communication. They express the ethical values in the following three ways.

- public message
- Employee manual and the policy statements
- Mission Statement and ethical codes.

Public message:-

In formal statement of organizational values and ethics appears in public msg usually moves from top-to-bottom. The organizational message for public is explained by the high-level executives. The high level executives use different channel of communication to

to communicate the ethics and values of organizations to employees and other subordinates.

Employee manual and policy statements.

Ethical statements appears in employee policy book and manuals which typically contain the rules and regulations of the organization. In such statements values and ethics moves from top to bottom. (etc)

Informal ways:-

In informal ways usually ethics are imported from individual.

● In this system the organization can make its own value system

● Ethical system and values system can also be adapted by behavior of the managers.